

**ACTIVITY 16 — LEARNER WORKSHEET****KPI Dashboard Design**

| TYPE       | DURATION   | MAPS TO | TOPIC                        |
|------------|------------|---------|------------------------------|
| Case Study | 20 minutes | LU4     | LU4 — Branding Effectiveness |

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|------|--|
| Name |  |
| Date |  |

**What you are doing**

The Board's ask is specific: it wants a KPI framework it can check every month after the relaunch, not a one-off report from Marketing whenever someone remembers to send it. The founder, who is not a numbers person, has asked for something she can read in five minutes and still trust.

**What you will produce:** A SMART KPI framework — 3 internal + 3 external KPIs, each with an owner, target, data source, review deadline and a missed-target trigger.

**The scenario**

Right now every department tracks something different — Marketing watches follower counts, Retail watches footfall, Customer Service watches response times — and none of it is compared against a target or a deadline. Last month someone reported "engagement is up" without saying up from what, or by when it should keep rising.

Your table's job is to turn this scattered activity into a small set of SMART KPIs the Board can actually govern the relaunch by.

**Your steps**

1. **Audit the current state** — List what each department tracks today: Marketing on followers, Retail on footfall, Customer Service on response times. Mark that none has a target or a deadline — that is precisely why 'engagement is up' was meaningless.
2. **Distinguish internal from external KPIs** — Internal KPIs measure what Nimbus does (response time, publishing cadence, staff training completion). External KPIs measure how the market responds (sentiment, repeat purchase, share of voice). A framework of only internal KPIs measures activity, not results.
3. **Select three of each** — Choose for decision value, not for ease of extraction. The test: if this number moved, would the Board actually do something differently? If not, cut it.
4. **Run one KPI through the full SMART test** — Take your weakest KPI and test it: Specific (exactly what is counted?), Measurable (from which system?), Achievable (given the team and budget?), Relevant (to the relaunch objective?), Time-bound (by when?). Note where it first breaks — usually Specific or Time-bound — and fix it.

5. **Repair the rest** — Apply the same test quickly to the remaining five and tighten each.
6. **Assign the four fields** — Every KPI needs a named owner (a person, not a department), a numeric target, a data source, and a review deadline. A KPI without an owner is nobody's job.
7. **Define the escalation** — Write what happens if a KPI misses target two months running — who is told, what gets reviewed, what decision is triggered. Without this the dashboard is reporting, not governance.
8. **Design the five-minute view** — The founder is not a numbers person. Choose the smallest set of numbers that still tells the whole story on one slide, and lay it out. Usually one headline number per pillar with a trend arrow.

## Your working space

Complete every field. You may keep this worksheet and refer to it during the open-book assessment.

### Step 1 — Audit the current state

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### Step 2 — Distinguish internal from external KPIs

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### Step 3 — Select three of each

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### Step 4 — Run one KPI through the full SMART test

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### Step 5 — Repair the rest

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### Step 6 — Assign the four fields

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### Step 7 — Define the escalation

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### Step 8 — Design the five-minute view

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### Answers to the discussion prompts

**1. Which 3 internal and 3 external KPIs would actually tell the Board whether the relaunch is working — not just which numbers are easiest for each department to pull?**

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**2. Take one of your KPIs through the full SMART test — where does it break down first, and how do you fix that?**

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**3. Who owns each KPI, and what happens if the number misses target two months in a row?**

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**4. If the Board can only look at one dashboard slide, what's the smallest set of numbers that still tells the whole story?**

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## Reflect & discuss

Which of your KPIs was hardest to make genuinely Measurable rather than just a description of activity?

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Did your table set a target that was Attainable, or did ambition win out over realism?

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If one KPI is red for two straight months, does your framework actually say what happens next — or does it stop at reporting the number?

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## Check your work

Every group can show 3 internal + 3 external KPIs, each SMART-tested with a named owner, target, data source and review deadline, and can explain what action a missed target would trigger.